RAVI LIYANARACHCHI

CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER | DENIM WOVEN & WASH

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COO – DENIM WOVEN & WASH | GAZIPUR, BANGLADESH

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Senior garment manufacturing and operations leader with 25+ years of international experience across Sri Lanka, Bangladesh and Vietnam, including extensive denim, woven pants, woven shirts and garment-wash operations. Proven leadership of large-scale manufacturing, Lean transformation, industrial engineering, supply chain, merchandising, quality, compliance and profitability. Led up to 60 production lines and 2,400 sewing operators, established Lean production facilities, improved production efficiency from 65% to 75%, and delivered measurable margin and cost improvements. Strong buyer-facing experience with global brands including Levi's, VF, Lee, Wrangler, Target Australia, Columbia, M&S, IZOD, CK, Tommy, Van Heusen and LPP.

COO FIT – DENIM WOVEN & WASH

- Denim / Woven / Wash: Deep manufacturing exposure across denim jeans, woven pants, woven shirts, jackets and washing operations.
- Operational Excellence: Pioneered Lean manufacturing plants, introduced Japanese woven manufacturing standards and applied IE/GSD/PMTS methods.
- P&L & Cost Optimisation: Improved profit margins by 10%; achieved 5% cost reduction through process optimisation and strategic sourcing.
- Large-Team Leadership: Led 60 production lines and 2,400 sewing operators across production, supply chain, merchandising, printing, embroidery, washing and packing.
- Delivery & Performance: Improved efficiency from 65% to 75%, achieved up to 100% on-time delivery and maintained A-grade supplier performance.
- Compliance & Quality: Led operations against international buyer and licensed quality standards with focus on quality, delivery, compliance and sustainable waste reduction.

SELECTED EXECUTIVE ACHIEVEMENTS

Leadership Area	Business Impact
P&L / Profitability	10% profit-margin improvement through Lean operations, CM loss control, productivity improvement and cost discipline.
Lean & Efficiency	Raised production efficiency from 65% to 75%; established Lean production systems and waste-reduction practices.
Manufacturing Scale	Led 60 production lines and 2,400 sewing operators; established a new project with 50 Lean lines.
Cost Optimisation	Delivered 5% cost reduction through process optimisation and strategic sourcing.
Delivery	Achieved 99–100% on-time delivery performance in major operations while maintaining quality standards.
Buyer / Brand Leadership	Worked with Levi's, VF, Lee, Wrangler, Target Australia, Columbia, M&S, IZOD, CK, Tommy, Van Heusen and LPP.

CORE COMPETENCIES

COO Leadership • Denim Woven & Wash • P&L & Budgeting • Cost Optimisation • Lean Manufacturing • Operational Excellence • Industrial Engineering / GSD / PMTS • Factory Scaling & Turnaround • Capacity Planning • Supply Chain & Vendor Management • Quality, Compliance & ESG • Merchandising & Buyer Relations • Team Development • ERP / Planning / Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager – Manufacturing | Suyamas International Pvt Ltd, King Koil USA Licensed Facility | Horana, Sri Lanka | 2020–2023 | 2025–Present

- Lead end-to-end manufacturing across quilting, latex processing, rebonded foam, spring manufacturing, assembly and packing, with responsibility for workflow, workforce planning, quality, cost efficiency and operational performance.

- Increased profit margins by 10% through manufacturing process improvements, cost control and stronger alignment between production and market requirements.
- Lead cross-functional improvements involving industrial engineering, marketing, logistics, vendor coordination, inventory, staff development and operational controls.
- Ensure compliance with international King Koil USA licensed quality standards and consistent product-quality performance.

Executive Director – Operations | Explore Garments Pvt Ltd (Hameem Group) | Dhaka, Bangladesh | 2023–2025

- Led establishment of a new project with 50 Lean production lines for woven pants and shirts for major international brands.
- Directed production operations, strategic planning, Lean implementation, efficiency, quality and production-floor performance.
- Built an innovative woven shirt production floor for IZOD, CK, Tommy, Columbia, Van Heusen and LPP and introduced Japanese woven manufacturing standards.
- Achieved 10% production-efficiency improvement and 5% cost reduction through process optimisation and strategic sourcing.

General Manager | Pearl Global Pvt Ltd / New World Fashion Group – Nam.Co | Hanoi, Vietnam | 2018–2020

- Managed overall woven factory operations including capacity planning, workforce optimisation, process improvement, quality and shipment performance.
- Improved production efficiency from 65% to 75%, achieved 0% lost time from production floor to packaging and maintained 100% on-time deliveries.
- Reduced cost-per-minute losses, improved margins and maintained A-grade supplier status with international customers.

General Manager – Operations & Technical | ZXY International | Chittagong, Bangladesh | 2016–2018

- Oversaw two manufacturing facilities covering development, sampling, production operations and supply chain management.
- Improved manpower utilisation, productivity and operational discipline and established structured technical training for production teams.
- Managed business operations with exposure to an organisation of 100 million turnover.

IE Group / Operations Manager / Unit Head | Ken Park Bangladesh Apparels (Pvt) Ltd | Chittagong, Bangladesh | 2001–2016

- Pioneered a fully Lean manufacturing plant supporting Levi's, VF, Lee, Wrangler, Target Australia and Columbia.
- Led 60 production lines and 2,400 sewing operators across supply chain, merchandising, printing, embroidery, washing and packaging.
- Specialised in denim jeans, casual/formal pants, jackets, schoolwear and children's apparel; implemented Lean systems to reduce waste and production losses and strengthen profitability.

IE & Lean Manager | Hirdaramani Mercury Apparels (Pvt) Ltd | Sri Lanka | 1997–2001

- Revitalised the Industrial Engineering function, recruited and trained IE teams, managed capacity planning and SMV costing using PMTS/GSD, and introduced Lean practices.

Production Executive | Hirdaramani Mercury Apparels (Pvt) Ltd | Sri Lanka | 1994–1996

- Prepared production schedules and shipment targets, coordinated pre-production/process planning with IE teams, and ensured customer, quality and production-standard compliance.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- Degree in Business Management – NIBM, Sri Lanka
- Advanced Diploma in Labour Management – IMS (UK)
- Industrial Engineering, Production Organisation & Quality Control – Textile Department, University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka
- Production Organisation and Management Program in Japan – AOTS, Toyota and Denso Company
- Diploma in Maintenance & Repairing of Industrial Sewing Machines

LEAN CERTIFICATION

- Nike Lean Graduate (Blue Belt) – 2013; continued Lean Manufacturing improvement toward Black Belt-level practice.

REFERENCES

Mr. Ajith De Silva – Former Managing Director, Ken Park Bangladesh (Pvt) Ltd, Chittagong, Bangladesh | +880 1713 109000
Mr. Nimal Perera – VP / Business Head, Epic Group Dhaka | +880 1731 771609